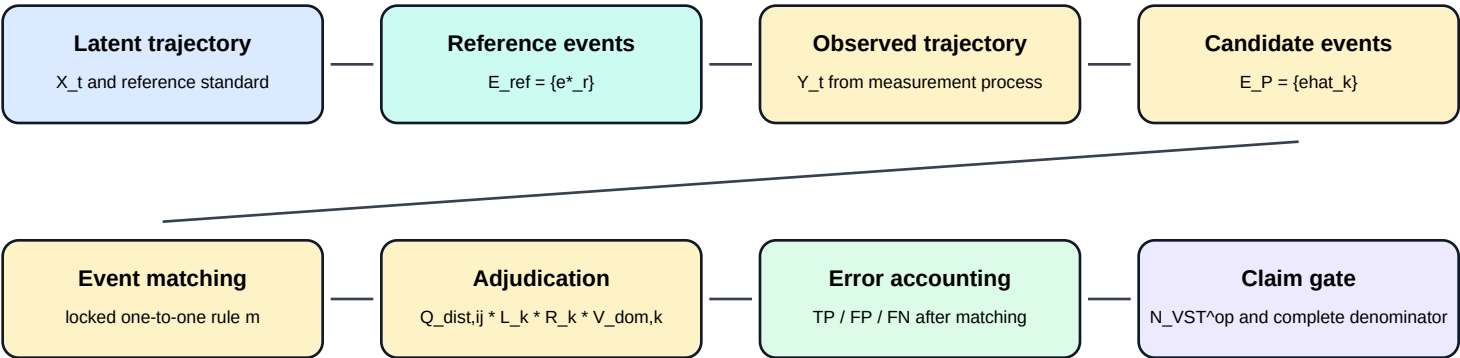


VSTF Event-Cascade and Claim-Governance Layer

Operational candidates and reference events are matched before error rates are claimed.



Rejected or unresolved observations remain auditable

- No Q_{dist} : proxy signal only; do not count as accepted transition.
- No localization: candidate event remains unresolved or rejected.
- No retention: acute response, not stabilized outcome.
- No V_{dom} : generic state movement, not domain-valid success.
- No complete denominator: may be state-valid but cannot support VSTE/cost-yield claims.

Locked numerator, matching, and denominator

A_k is evaluated on detected candidates; reference validity belongs to matched reference events.
Unmatched accepted candidates are false acceptances; unmatched valid references are false rejections.
Cost-normalized claims additionally require Q_B^{acct} and a declared boundary B .

Reviewer-facing interpretation

VSTF is not a new transition detector. It is a pre-specified adjudication and claim-governance layer placed after or alongside transition detection, before a detected event enters an outcome numerator.